Resources for Support

Professionals

Professionals: Consult with specialized clinics, such as paediatric feeding disorder programs, which offer specialized diagnostic and treatment services.

Training and Education

Education: Seek out resources that offer training on safe feeding practices and behavioural interventions.

Challenges and Considerations

- Common Disorders: Feeding issues are prevalent in children with autism, developmental delays, and cerebral palsy.
- Root Causes: Challenges often stem from sensory processing issues, poor coordination of suck/swallow, food selectivity, and oral-motor deficits.
- Parental Support: It is crucial to address the stress, anxiety, and guilt reported by caregivers to improve the overall family dynamic during meals.
- Adolescent Focus: For teenagers, focus on addressing picky eating habits, nutritional deficits, and disordered eating behaviours.

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UNIVERSITY of SOUTHERN CARIBBEAN

SPECIAL EDUCATION & NUTRITION

MODULE 12

PROFESSOR:Ms. Shandera Smith

STUDENT: Mrs. SHARON DENNY TOMLINSON

DATE: April 20 th , 2026

ASSIGNMENT #2

Create an education 75 second video (audio-visual) and pamphlet on the following topic:

Address feeding challenges in children and teenagers with developmental disorders and disabilities.

Addressing feeding challenges in children and teenagers with developmental disabilities requires a multidisciplinary approach involving Specialized Therapy (OT, Speech), Structured Environments, and Sensory-Based Strategies.

THE FOLLOWING OUTLINES CAUSE EFFECT INTERVENTION FOR CORRECTION IMPROVEMENT MANAGEMENT SUCCESS.

Because of common issues like early or delayed intervention, food selectivity, refusal, independence, economic challenges, oral-motor difficulties, knowledge on barriers affecting the individual and other personal factors. Feeding can be managed through gradual exposure, adapted tools (special utensils), establishing consistent calm routines, create low-stress activities, modifying food textures, and working with Specialists.

Key strategies

include sensory- friendly environments, positive reinforcement for trying foods, and ensuring proper seating posture to ensure safety and comfort.

Key Interventions

- **Multidisciplinary Approach**: Collaborate with specialized professionals, including Paediatricians, Occupational Therapists (OTs) for sensory issues, and Speech- Language Pathologists (SLPs) for oral-motor and swallowing issues.

- **Sensory-Based Techniques**: Use play-based food exploration to reduce anxiety and increase comfort with new textures, smells, an tastes, such as encouraging touching or playing with food before eating.

Key Inventions Con't

- **Environmental Structuring: Create a consistent, calm, and low-distraction mealtime environment. This includes using specialized feeding equipment like adapted spoons, cups, and plates**

- **Gradual Exposure/Desensitization**: Gradually introduce new foods in small, non-threatening steps starting by simply having the food on the table, then touching it, then placing it in the mouth.

- **Addressing Oral-Motor Skills**: Utilize tools like a Z- vibe or specific exercises provided by SLPs to improve chewing, biting, and swallowing, particularly for children with neuromotor disabilities.

- **Behavioral Support**: Implement, with professional guidance, behavioural treatments to address food refusal, selectivity, and disruptive behaviours.